TEAM DECISION BRIEF

Remove the Granola Capture Requirement

Scribe | 14 October 2026 | Prepared for product and engineering

Recommendation: Keep Granola as an optional transcript source. Prove a calendar-connected, explicitly opted-in Recall meeting bot on one supported platform. In parallel, evaluate Zoom RTMS for botless capture if visible bot participants are unacceptable. Do not use Google Meet's REST transcript API for leadership evaluation without resolving Google's explicit policy restriction.

Why this matters

Scribe currently depends on a transcript being created elsewhere before it can analyze a meeting. Granola MCP and webhooks do not create that transcript: MCP reads notes the user can already access, and webhooks notify Scribe after a note is generated, edited, or shared. If Granola was not capturing, there is no new Granola transcript for Scribe to retrieve.

The product goal is achievable without requiring Granola on the user's computer, but not without a capture source, appropriate permissions, and clear participant notice.

Options at a glance

Path
What it enables
Main caveat
Assessment

Recall calendar + meeting bot
Connect a user's Google or Outlook calendar, select eligible events, schedule a bot, then ingest the transcript.
The bot is a visible meeting participant. Hosts/lobbies can block admission. Requires consent UX and calendar OAuth.
Best MVP proof

Recall Zoom RTMS
Botless Zoom media capture through Zoom's real-time media stream integration.
Requires Zoom app setup, required scopes and application review; the host/workspace must enable the relevant behavior.
Evaluate next

Google Meet Media API
Botless real-time Google Meet media access through Recall.

Developer Preview is no longer accepting new signups; current docs require all participants in Google's developer program.

Do not plan MVP around it

Native Meet transcript API

Retrieve Meet transcript artifacts after a meeting when configured and authorized.
Google explicitly says the Meet REST API is not intended for performance tracking or user evaluation within a domain.

Policy blocker for Scribe

Microsoft Graph transcripts

Retrieve transcripts from eligible scheduled Teams meetings.
Requires Microsoft permissions and tenant controls; availability and meeting eligibility vary.

Potential enterprise connector

Recommended MVP

1. **Pick one supported meeting platform** based on the team's actual test accounts. Avoid a multi-provider launch.
2. **Connect one calendar through Recall Calendar V2.** Give the user an explicit per-meeting capture choice; calendar access must not silently mean permission to record or analyze every event.
3. **Schedule a Recall bot for one consented test meeting.** Confirm the bot can join, what participants see, how host admission works, and what failure states occur.
4. **Handle lifecycle webhooks asynchronously.** Verify signatures, deduplicate event deliveries, acknowledge quickly, and enqueue transcript retrieval and analysis.
5. **Normalize the transcript into Scribe's existing meeting/analysis flow.** Keep provider-specific capture logic behind an adapter so Granola remains a supported optional source.
6. **Run a privacy and retention review.** Define consent, transcript retention/deletion, access controls, and a clear disconnect/stop-capture path before real-user testing.

Success criterion: A test user who has no Granola installation can explicitly select a supported meeting, receive clear notice that capture is active, and get a Scribe insight from the resulting transcript. A failed join or unavailable transcript must be shown as a failure, not a successful sync.

Architecture direction

Add a provider-independent capture pipeline:

Calendar connection

Authorize calendar access; list events and allow user selection.

Capture orchestrator

Apply consent/preferences and schedule, update, or cancel capture for an event.

Provider adapters

Granola API/webhooks, Recall bot, and later native provider transcripts.

Webhook intake + job queue

Verify and deduplicate callbacks; return 2xx quickly; process work asynchronously.

Transcript normalization

Map provider IDs, timestamps, speaker attribution, and source metadata to a common Scribe schema.

Existing coaching pipeline

Analyze evidence and generate private strength, growth-area, and micro-action insights.

Risks to resolve

- **Visibility and consent:** A bot is a participant, not an invisible recorder. Admission policies and consent requirements may prevent capture.
- **Privacy:** Scribe's backend still needs authentication and owner-scoped data access before real users' leadership insights can be treated as private.
- **Provider policy:** Google Meet REST API's stated restriction conflicts with Scribe's user-evaluation purpose; avoid it absent written policy clearance.
- **Speaker quality:** Do not promise talk-time or leader-specific conclusions when speaker attribution is uncertain.
- **Operational cost/reliability:** Evaluate vendor pricing, regions, retention, webhook retries, waiting rooms, failed joins, and duplicate calendar events in the proof of concept.

APPENDIX

Evidence & Sources

Vendor capabilities and restrictions below were checked against the providers' published documentation on 14 October 2026. A documentation review is not a substitute for testing with Scribe's actual accounts or obtaining policy approval.

Granola

- How Granola transcribes meetings — capture requires a user-started note; Granola says it has no meeting bot.
- Granola MCP — access/search existing notes and transcripts, subject to

user authorization and scope.

- Granola webhooks — note-generated/edited/access-granted notifications; fetch note contents separately.

Recall.ai

- Calendar V2 integration and scheduling guide — user calendar authorization, event decisions, scheduling and deduplication.
- Bot overview, Google Meet, and Microsoft Teams — bots are call participants and platform-specific join/lobby constraints.
- Bot lifecycle webhooks — joining, waiting-room, recording, done, and fatal status events.
- Meeting Direct Connect, Zoom RTMS, and Google Meet Media API — botless capture paths and requirements.

Google and Microsoft

- Google Meet REST API overview — includes the restriction on performance tracking/user evaluation within a domain.
- Google Meet artifacts — transcript/recording artifact configuration, retrieval, and retention.
- Google Meet Media API overview — preview status and consent requirements.
- Microsoft Graph: List transcripts — eligible meetings, permissions, and tenant controls.

Prepared as a product/engineering decision brief for the Scribe team. Recommendation: run one opt-in bot-capture vertical slice before investing in multiple provider integrations.